Welcome to the LVNA

Villager

The Newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

Volume 51, Number 1 | Sunnyvale, California | January 2008

Next LVNA General Meeting
Wednesday, January 9
at 7 p.m. in the Lakewood Park Building

- **Neighborhood Safety**
- **How To Save Energy and Money**

President's Column

-Michael Majchrowicz

Happy New Year! You will see changes in the *Villager* and in the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association in 2008. This is the last *Villager* issue edited by Faith Rogers; we thank her for her years of service.

Christy Majchrowicz will take over the editing position, but the positions of Advertising Coordinator and Treasurer still must be filled, so please contact me if you are interested, or know someone who can help. My contact information is on the back of the *Villager*.

The next LVNA meeting is Wednesday, January 9. The main topic will be how to keep our neighborhood safe. Your comments and ideas are welcome.

There was a string of burglaries in south Sunnyvale during 2007, and in December we in Lakewood Village suffered the same. We need to take the safety of our neighborhood very seriously. We all need to be aware of how we can prevent these crimes (see the article on burglary prevention on page 3), and how to look out for our neighbors, so that they will look out for us.

I hope that 2007 was a wonderful and productive year for you all, and that 2008 will be even better! ■

Holiday Lighting Contest Winners

LVNA President Michael Majchrowicz and Sunnyvale Department of Public Safety Captain Chris Carrion drove around the Village on December 14 to determine the winners of the annual Holiday Lighting Contest:

For Quadrant 1 (north of Sandia): 1117 Palamos.

For Quadrant 2 (north of Lakehaven) and Overall Winner: 666 Lakefair.

For Quadrant 3 (south of Lakehaven): 722 Lakewood.

For Quadrant 4 (south of Sandia): 1319 Soccorro.

All winners will receive a Pizza Depot gift certificate, courtesy of owner Toto Lukito.

Congratulations, winners! You really lit up the holiday season in Lakewood Village. ■

LVNA Positions Now Open

Treasurer:
Deposit funds received from *Villager* advertisers and for grants
Balance LVNA checking account
Reimburse for materials for neighborhood events

***Villager* Ad Coordinator:**
Obtain ads from local businesses for the *Villager*—the source of most of LVNA's operating funds
Coordinate ads with the *Villager* editor
Help businesses put together creative ads, to market themselves effectively.
Print invoices for ads, and mail or deliver them

To volunteer, call Michael Majchrowicz at 886-8037. ■

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Village Crime Statistics

The Department of Public Safety has provided these crime statistics for Lakewood Village for November 2007.

Assault 1
Burglary 1
Larceny 2
Vehicle burglary 1 ■

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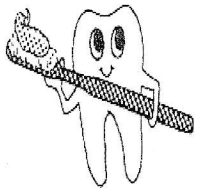
Energy Saving Workshop Coming to Lakewood Village

At the LVNA general meeting at the Lakewood Park building on January 9, 2008 at 7 p.m., you can learn about a workshop for the neighborhood designed to help us all take action in our homes and lives to save energy and money.

If you are interested, please contact Ursula Syrova at 408-738-3092 or vicepresident1@lvna.net. ■

FRANCISCO A. MABBAYAD, D.M.D.

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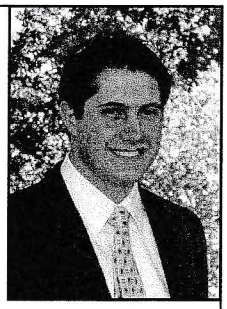


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To subscribe to the Lakewood Village mailing list, send a blank e-mail to: lakewoodvillage-subscribe@topica.com

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Attention, neighbors and small business owners:

Three thieves (women) and a getaway driver (man) took a backpack with a wallet from Instyle Beauty Salon on December 11, 2007.

The women, pretending to be customers, distracted the owner with questions and requests. After they left the salon, the backpack was gone. The women were seen being picked up by a van driven by a man.

The police arrived within 5 minutes after the 911 call.

I want to warn everyone to be on the lookout for these four con artists and thieves. If you are a business owner, be wary of customers who ask too many questions, because they might be trying to distract you. Keep your valuable belongings in a safe place, whether you are the owner or a customer of a business.

I hope you have a safe New Year.

-Lynh Banh



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How To Prevent Burglaries

The basics:

Make your home look occupied, and make it difficult to break in. Lock all outside doors and windows before you leave the house or go to bed. Even if it is for a short time, lock your doors. Leave lights on when you go out. If you will be away overnight or longer, connect some lamps to automatic timers to turn them on in the evening and off during the day. Keep your garage door closed and locked. Don't allow daily deliveries of mail, newspapers, or flyers to build up while you are away. Arrange with the U.S. Post Office to hold your mail, or arrange for a friend or neighbor to take them in regularly. Arrange for your lawn to be mowed if you are going away for an extended time. Check locks on doors and windows; replace them with secure devices as necessary. Pushbutton locks on doorknobs are easy for burglars to open. Install deadbolt locks on all your outside doors. Special locks are available for sliding glass doors, for better security.

Don't tempt a thief:

Lawn mowers, barbecues and bicycles are best stored out of sight. Always lock garden sheds and garages. Use curtains on garage and basement windows. Never leave notes on your door such as "Gone shopping."

continued on page 4

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How To Prevent Burglaries *continued from page 3*

Locks...get the best:
No lock, regardless of its quality, can be truly effective. Key-in deadbolt locks provide minimum security. Ask a locksmith for advice on your situation. Change locks immediately if your keys are lost or stolen. When moving into a new home, have all locks changed.

Outside:
Have adequate exterior lighting. A motion-sensor light is recommended for backyards. Trim trees and shrubs so that they cannot be used as hiding places for intruders. Make sure your door hinges are on the inside. Install bells on your exterior gates. Install "Beware of Dog" signs (whether or not you have a dog).

Windows:
Windows may need better locks. Check with a locksmith or hardware store for alternatives. Most windows can be pinned for security. Drill a 3/16-inch hole on a slight downward slant through the inside window frame and halfway into the outside frame. Place a nail in the hole to secure the window.

Alarms:
An alarm system provides peace of mind to homeowners, especially those on vacation. There is a wide variety of alarm systems on the market. Check several different companies for the best one for you.

If your home is broken into:
If you come home to find an unexplained open or broken window or door: Do not enter—the perpetrator may still be inside. Use a neighbor's phone to call police. Do not touch anything or clean up until the police have inspected for evidence. Write down the license-plate numbers of any suspicious vehicles. Note descriptions of any suspicious persons.

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How To Prevent Burglaries *continued from page 4*

Other precautions you should take:

Never leave keys under doormats, flowerpots, mailboxes or other "secret" hiding places—burglars know where to look for hidden keys. Keep a detailed inventory of your valuable possessions, including a description of the items, date of purchase and original value, and serial numbers, and keep a copy in a safe place away from home; this is also a good precaution in case of fires or other disasters. Make a photographic or video record of valuable objects, heirlooms, and antiques. Your insurance company can provide assistance in making and keeping your inventory. Trim the shrubbery around your home to reduce cover for burglars. Be a good neighbor. If you notice anything suspicious in your neighborhood, call 911 immediately. Put your driver license number on your valuables with an engraving pen. Marked items are harder for a burglar to dispose of and easier for police to recover. Form a Neighborhood Watch Group. The Department of Public Safety can help you work with your neighbors to improve security and reduce risk of burglary.

The most important thing you can do is call the police to report a crime or any suspicious activity. You have to be the eyes of your neighborhood. And remember, you can always remain anonymous eyes!

Call the Sunnyvale Department of Public Safety and schedule your free Home Security Survey (408-730-7116). ■

Fairwood PTG Rummage Sale Slated for April

Save your unneeded extras for the Fairwood School rummage sale. To raise money for the school, the Parent-Teacher Group will hold this sale during the first weekend in April.

Start now to save clothes, toys, books, and other items you no longer need. ■

"To the praise of the glory of His grace..."

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Delivery (Lakewood)	Wendy Stanley	walkers@lvna.net	745-1331
http://www.lvna.net/Miscellany/Contact/contact.html			

Internet Links

LVNA Web Site	http://www.lvna.net
Lakewood Village E-mail List	http://www.topica.com/lists/lakewoodvillage
City of Sunnyvale	http://www.sunnyvale.ca.gov
Sunnyvale Library	http://www.sunnyvalelibrary.org
Sunnyvale Free Recycling	http://groups.yahoo.com/group/sunnyvalefree/
http://www.lvna.net/Resources/Links/links.html	

Upcoming Events

What	Where	When
Street Sweeping	Your street – move your cars!	1/8 Fairwood 1/15 Lakewood 2/5 Fairwood 2/12 Lakewood
Compost Workshop	Sunnyvale Community Center Arboretum	1/19 10 a.m. – noon
Household Hazardous Waste Drop-off	Carl Road, near the SMaRT Station	1/19 8 a.m. – 1 p.m.
LVNA *Villager* Editorial Deadline	Contact editor@lvna.net	1/31
LVNA Meeting	Lakewood Park Bldg.	1/9, 7 p.m.

Important Phone Numbers

Public Safety – Emergency	**911**
Public Safety – Non-emergency	**730-7100**
Parks and Maintenance	730-7506
Speeding cars; parking complaints; traffic signal repair; dead animals	Dispatch 730-7180
Noise complaints; homeless complaints; commercial vehicles on residential streets	Desk Officer 730-7110
Illegal storage or buildings; decrepit fences or buildings; weed problems; illegal home businesses; rental housing complaints; commercial vehicles on private property	Neighborhood Preservation 730-7610
Animal control	730-7178
City streets, sidewalks, trees, streetlights, street sweeping	Public Works 730-7505
Nuisance vehicle hotline	730-7706
Drug hotline	245-3784
Graffiti hotline	730-7680
Shopping cart pickup	730-7680
Neighborhood liaison	730-7472
http://www.lvna.net/Resources/Phones/phones.html	



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